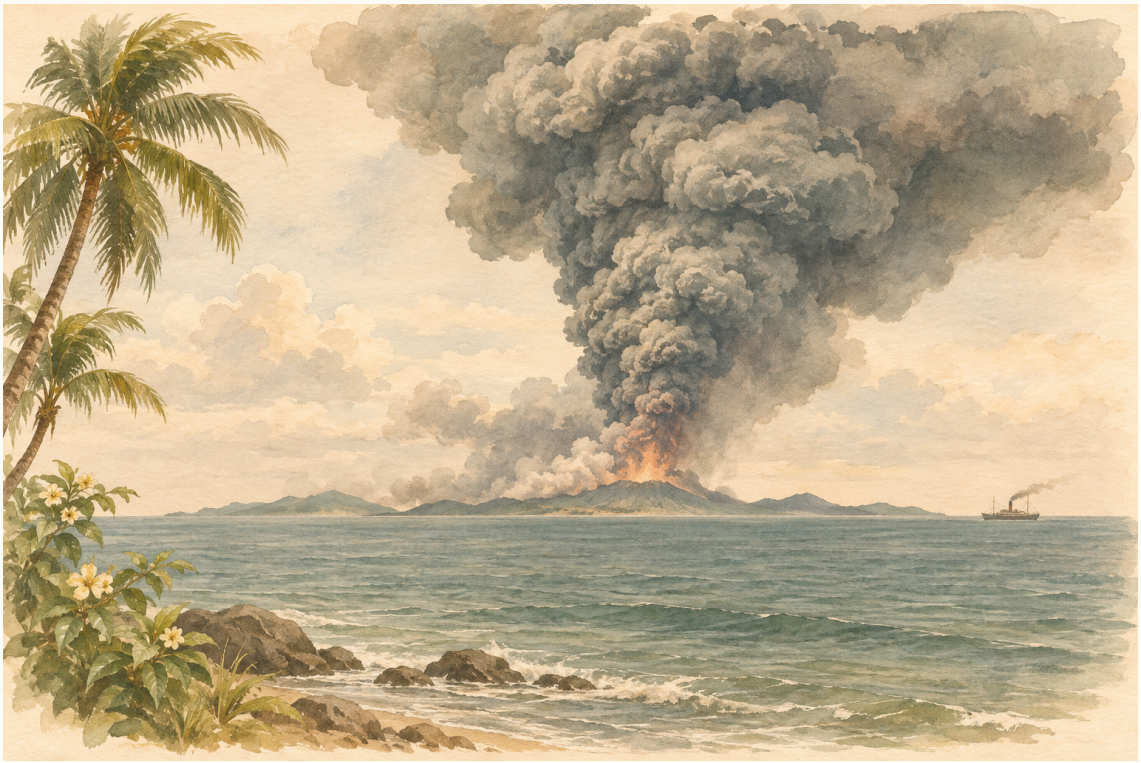
震动世界的一声巨响

The Sound That Shook the World



火山的一声巨响，如何传遍世界？

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

Shortly after ten in the morning on 27 August 1883, Krakatoa, a volcanic island in the Sunda Strait, unleashed its most thunderous explosion. About four hours later, islanders on Rodrigues, nearly 4,800 kilometres across the Indian Ocean, took the roar for distant gunfire. Barometers worldwide recorded the atmospheric pressure wave, some of them seven times in about five days.

Restless since 20 May, the volcano reached a catastrophic climax on 26–27 August. About two-thirds of the island collapsed into its emptied magma chamber, vanishing beneath the sea. Tsunamis, reportedly over 30 metres high in places, swamped coastal settlements on Java and Sumatra. Dutch colonial administrators counted 36,417 dead, mostly drowned, perhaps underestimating the toll.

Telegrams from Batavia (now Jakarta), relayed by submarine cable, reached London within hours. Western newspapers soon began chronicling what is often called the first global news event. Yet early dispatches were terse; the magnitude of the devastation emerged piecemeal over days.

Ash and sulphur dioxide, hurled tens of kilometres high, formed a haze that circled the equator in about two weeks. In November 1883, crimson sunsets glowed over Europe and North America, summoning firefighters in New York and Connecticut to phantom blazes. Later climate reconstructions suggest global temperatures dipped a few tenths of a degree the following year.

Some experts discounted the volcanic explanation, blaming the sunsets on moisture at high altitude or cosmic dust. In February 1884, Britain's Royal Society appealed in The Times for dated observations, eliciting worldwide replies; the Society's 1888 report tied the glow to Krakatoa. Through barometers, cables, and crimson skies, far-flung observers began to glimpse how interconnected the planet already was.

中文译文

1883年8月27日上午10点刚过，巽他海峡的火山岛喀拉喀托发生了最震耳欲聋的一次爆炸。约四小时后，远隔印度洋、距其近4800公里的罗德里格斯岛居民，把轰鸣误当成远处的炮声。世界各地的气压计都记录到了大气压力波，一些仪器在大约五天内录到了七次。

火山自5月20日起便躁动不安，到了8月26日至27日，活动达到灾难性的高潮。约三分之二的岛体塌入已被排空的岩浆房，没入海中。据报道，局部高逾30米的海啸淹没了爪哇和苏门答腊的沿海居民点。荷兰殖民当局统计死亡36417人，大多为溺亡，而这一数字还可能偏低。

从巴达维亚，也就是今天的雅加达发出的电报，经海底电缆转发，数小时内便抵达伦敦。西方报纸很快开始报道这起常被称为首个全球新闻事件的灾难。然而，早期电讯十分简短，灾情究竟有多严重，直到几天后才逐渐清楚。

火山灰和二氧化硫被抛向数十公里高空，形成的薄雾约用两周便绕赤道一圈。1883年11月，深红的晚霞照亮欧洲和北美；纽约州和康涅狄格州的消防员甚至被引去扑救并不存在的大火。后来的气候重建研究推测，次年全球气温下降了零点几度。

一些专家不接受火山解释，认为晚霞来自高空水汽或宇宙尘埃。1884年2月，英国皇家学会通过《泰晤士报》征集注明日期的观测记录，得到世界各地的回应；学会1888年的报告将红霞与喀拉喀托联系起来。借助气压计、电缆和绯红的天空，相隔遥远的观测者开始看见：地球各处原来早已相互关联。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

unleash v.
释放；迸发出
unleashed its most thunderous

thunderous adj.
雷鸣般响亮的
its most thunderous explosion.

barometer n.
气压计
Barometers worldwide recorded the

atmospheric adj.
大气的
the atmospheric pressure wave,

catastrophic adj.
灾难性的
a catastrophic climax on 26–27 August.

climax n.
高潮；顶点
a catastrophic climax on 26–27 August.

collapse into phr.v.
塌入
the island collapsed into its emptied

reportedly adv.
据报道
Tsunamis, reportedly over 30 metres

swamp v.
淹没
swamped coastal settlements on Java

underestimate v.
低估
perhaps underestimating the toll.

toll n.
死亡人数；伤亡总数
perhaps underestimating the toll.

relay v.
转发；传递
relayed by submarine cable,

terse adj.
简短的
Yet early dispatches were terse;

magnitude n.
规模；程度
the magnitude of the devastation

devastation n.
严重破坏；浩劫
the devastation emerged piecemeal over

piecemeal adv.
一点一点地
the devastation emerged piecemeal over

haze n.
薄雾；霾
haze that circled the equator in about

reconstruction n.
重建；历史状况复原
Later climate reconstructions suggest

discount v.
不予采信；低估
Some experts discounted the volcanic

elicit v.
引起；引出
eliciting worldwide replies;

far-flung adj.
相隔遥远的
far-flung observers began to glimpse

interconnected adj.
相互关联的
how interconnected the planet already

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共42项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

volcanic adj.
火山的

strait n.
海峡

islander n.
岛民

roar n.
轰鸣；咆哮声

distant adj.
远处的

gunfire n.
炮火声；枪炮射击

restless adj.
躁动不安的

emptied adj.
被排空的

magma n.
岩浆

vanish v.
消失

tsunami n.
海啸

coastal adj.
沿海的

settlement n.
居民点；聚居地

colonial adj.
殖民地的

administrator n.
行政官员

drown v.
溺亡

telegram n.
电报

submarine adj.
海底的

cable n.
电缆

chronicle v.
记述；报道

dispatch n.
电讯；发回的报道

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共42项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

ash n.
灰；此处指火山灰

sulphur n.
硫

hurl v.
猛抛；抛射

equator n.
赤道

crimson adj.
深红色的

glow v.
发光；泛出光彩

summon v.
召来

firefighter n.
消防员

phantom adj.
虚幻的；并不存在的

blaze n.
大火

dip v.
小幅下降

sunset n.
晚霞；日落

moisture n.
水汽；水分

at high altitude prep.phr.
在高空

cosmic adj.
宇宙的

Royal Society proper n.
英国皇家学会

appeal v.
呼吁

tie to phr.v.
与to连用：把……联系起来

to prep.
标示联系到的对象

observer n.
观察者；观测者

glimpse v.
初步认识到；窥见

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 _____ its most thunderous explosion.

02 Tsunamis, _____ over 30 metres high in places,

03 Yet early dispatches were _____;

04 how _____ the planet already was.

文章主线

- 巨响 1883年喀拉喀托火山喷发，声传近4800公里；全球气压计录到压力波，有些约5天录到7次。
- 灾难 约三分之二岛体塌入已排空的岩浆房并没入海中；海啸据报局部逾30米，官方记36417人死亡，多数溺亡，或仍低估。
- 快讯 海底电缆让电报数小时到伦敦，消息迅速全球传播；但早期报道简短，灾情规模数日后才逐渐清楚。
- 余波 火山灰和二氧化硫形成高空薄雾，远方出现红霞；后来的气候重建提示，1884年全球降温零点几度。
- 考证 有人把红霞归于高空水汽或宇宙尘埃；皇家学会汇集全球观测，1888年报告将红霞与喷发联系起来。

参考答案　1 unleashed 2 reportedly 3 terse 4 interconnected